

Question ID: 002dba45

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Medium

Question

Line k is defined by $y = -\frac{17}{3}x + 5$. Line j is perpendicular to line k in the xy -plane. What is the slope of line j ?

Correct Answer: .1764, .1765, 3/17

Rationale

The correct answer is $\frac{3}{17}$. It's given that line j is perpendicular to line k in the xy -plane. This means that the slope of line j is the negative reciprocal of the slope of line k . The equation of line k , $y = -\frac{17}{3}x + 5$, is written in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line and b is the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of the line. It follows that the slope of line k is $-\frac{17}{3}$. The negative reciprocal of a number is -1 divided by the number. Therefore, the negative reciprocal of $-\frac{17}{3}$ is $\frac{-1}{-\frac{17}{3}}$, or $\frac{3}{17}$. Thus, the slope of line j is $\frac{3}{17}$. Note that 3/17, .1764, .1765, and 0.176 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.